25901255

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

Fourth SEMESTER MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026

Value Addition Course (VAC) - MG4VACENG200 - LITERATURE AND ENVIRONMENT

Duration: 1 hour 30 minutes Maximum Marks: 50

Part A. MCQ. Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. In Ursula K. Le Guin's "The Direction of the Road," the road is later described as [U] / [CO1]
   Answer: a). full of shadows, pools, flowers, and rocks
2. Basheer's conclusion leaves the reader with a sense of [U] / [CO2]
   Answer: c). Reflection and moral responsibility
3. Who serves as the central character in MAN (2020)? [K] / [CO3]
   Answer: a). Man
4. The statement "The people had done it themselves" in Rachel Carson's "A Fablefor Tomorrow" expresses the theme of [U] / [CO1]
   Answer: b). human-caused catastrophe and accountability
5. In the essay, Basheer suggests that the true "inheritors of the earth" are [U] / [CO2]
   Answer: c). Animals and Insects

[1x5 = 5]

Part B. SHORT ANSWER. Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks.

6. In "A Fable for Tomorrow," how does Rachel Carson use the "checkerboard" image to connect human settlement with agriculture and order? [K] / [CO1]
   Answer: Carson uses the image of a "checkerboard" to describe the neatly arranged fields and farms of rural America. -- image suggests human effort to organise nature into systematic, controlled patterns -- land is divided into geometric sections, reflecting agricultural planning and human intervention -- conveys a sense of harmony between human settlement and the natural environment -- hints at human dominance over nature. -- once orderly "checkerboard" turns silent and lifeless, emphasise fragility of human-imposed order
7. Discuss the initial setting of the poem "The First Meeting" [An] / [CO2]
   Answer: Sujatha Bhatt -- opens in a quiet, intimate natural setting -- reflects calmness and emotional anticipation -- surroundings are described with sensitivity-- environment is an active presence that shapes the mood of the encounter. -- initial calm contrasts with the emotional complexity that unfolds later in the poem. The natural setting also reinforces themes of connection, memory and cultural identity
8. Examine how "Plastik" employs a child's imagination to communicate its environmental message. [U] / [CO3]
   Answer: Plastik uses a child's perspective to simplify a complex issue --playful imagination -- plastic waste is transformed into vivid, fantastical images. This creative lens makes pollution appear both familiar and disturbing. The innocence of the child contrasts sharply with the severity of environmental damage -- suggests what seems harmless in daily life accumulates into long-term ecological harm
9. In Ramanujan's "Ecology," discuss how the phrase "seeded… by a passing bird's providential droppings" shapes the poem's view of chance and destiny in nature. [E] / [CO1]
   Answer: highlights the interplay between randomness and purpose in nature -- an accidental act, a bird's droppings --"providential" suggests a sense of design -- presents nature as a space where chance events lead to meaningful outcomes -- reflects a broader ecological view -- nature operates through a balance of unpredictability and subtle order.
10. Offer a critical commentary on the climax of the short film MAN. [E] / [CO3]

Answer: MAN by Steve Cutts -- climax shows humans destroying the environment -- cause their own downfall -- turning point -- collapse of ecosystems or the extinction of species, followed by the decline of human dominance – Humans become victims of their own exploitation

11. Explain the metaphorical representation of the seed in the short film "The Seed". [U] / [CO3]
    Answer: Andy Matthews, the seed symbolises hope, renewal and ecological continuity --the potential for life even in damaged environments-- metaphor suggests that small beginnings can lead to significant change, but only if nurtured responsibly -- future of planet lies in present actions.
12. Explain the significance of the title "Tomorrow". [An] / [CO3]
    Answer: suggests both hope and urgency -- future as a space shaped by present choices -- film emphasises that environmental issues cannot be postponed indefinitely -- “Tomorrow” reminds the consequences of today’s actions
13. Comment on the relevance and deeper meaning of the title "Waste". [U] / [CO3]
    Answer: Waste refers to waste like plastic and garbage -- deeper level, it suggests the wastage of natural resources, human responsibility ecological balance -- film critiques consumer culture and careless disposal practices -- implies that waste is not merely material but also ethical
14. Discuss the significance of the title “The World Is Too Much with Us.” [An] / [CO2]
    Answer: Wordsworth’s title reflects influence of materialism. “Too much” suggests excess and imbalance -- title captures conflict between harmony and alienation -- critique of society that values possession over perception

[5x6 = 30]

Part C. ESSAY. Answer any1 question. Each question carries 15 marks

15. Using Ursula K. Le Guin’s story, critically examine the symbolism of motorcars as agents of alienation, speed, and ecological violence. [E] / [CO1]
    Answer: Guin uses a tree’s perspective to challenge human-centred views -- Motorcars symbolise alienation, speed and ecological violence, separating humans from nature and disrupting its rhythm-- reflect obsession with control and efficiency, exposing ignorance and environmental harm
16. Analyse “The Day the Bulldozers Came” as a poem of protest. [An] / [CO2]
    Answer: Orme presents a protest against environmental destruction and unchecked development. Bulldozers symbolise industrial power imposing human will on nature. poem’s tone of anger and loss highlights irreversible damage -- critiques progress-driven exploitation -- vivid imagery urge ethical responsibility and ecological awareness
17. "One Earth" is a journey through time. Explain. [U] / [CO3]
    Answer: Pennes presents a time-based visual journey from harmony to ecological crisis --show human-driven transformation, technological growth, environmental decline. Through future-oriented projections, minimal dialogue and shifting imagery, it emphasises shared responsibility and urges action -- highlighting how present choices shape an uncertain yet consequential future for Earth.

[15x1 = 15]